Nov 1st, 2026 Editor: Advaith K High: 61°F Low: 40°F

News Weekly

A 700,000-year-old elephant tooth reveals a lost world where early humans lived

The discovery of an ancient elephant tooth in northern Israel is offering scientists a fascinating glimpse into a world that existed nearly 700,000 years ago. This fossil, from the straight-tusked elephant Palaeoloxodon antiquus, was found at the Gesher Benot Ya'aqov site, where early humans made stone tools from basalt. Led by Hannah Farrell, researchers used CT scans, isotope geochemistry, and pollen analysis to recreate a prehistoric landscape rich with forests, rivers, and wetlands. This environment supported giant mammals and early humans, offering a crucial ecological refuge in the Levantine Corridor—a vital migration route linking Africa and Eurasia. The study underscores the importance of water and resources for survival and movement, highlighting the interaction between ancient humans and their surroundings. By examining these habitats, scientists gain insights into the conditions shaping human evolution and migration patterns, revealing how ancient landscapes influenced early human survival in a rapidly changing world. (Science Daily)



64th National Park designated as Chiricahua National Park

Chiricahua National Park, recently designated as the 64th national park in the United States, is a stunning landscape located in southeastern Arizona. Known to Native Americans as the Land of Standing-Up Rocks, this 19-square-mile area is notable for its towering rock spires, rich Apache heritage, and remarkable biodiversity. Originally designated as a national monument in the 1920s, the park preserves unique geological formations created by ancient volcanic activity. The site has a deep historical significance, being the traditional territory of the Chiricahua Apache tribes and later a station for Buffalo soldiers. This new designation aims to increase tourism, bolster local economies, and ensure the protection of both the natural landscape and its cultural heritage for future generations. It also allows for tribal access for traditional ceremonies and protects cultural uses. Despite its new status, the park faces challenges from prior cuts to the National Park Service workforce, which have led to delays in maintenance projects.



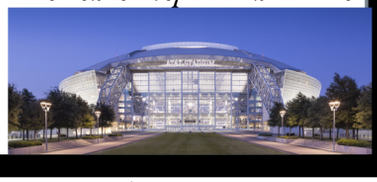
Could a giant sunshade in space 'solve global warming'? Scientists are taking the idea seriously

The concept of using solar geoengineering to address climate change sparks heated debate among scientists and policymakers alike. While Elon Musk's suggestion of "sentient satellites" may sound like science fiction, there is genuine research into space-based methods for reflecting sunlight away from Earth. The Planetary Sunshade Institute's recent report suggests the possibility of building a planetary sunshade within the next few decades, contingent on advancements in heavy-lift rocket technology. Although the cost of space launches is decreasing, making such projects seem more attainable, the approach remains controversial. Critics argue that geoengineering could have unforeseen environmental impacts and may divert attention from the critical task of reducing greenhouse-gas emissions. Nonetheless, as the threat of surpassing 1.5 °C of warming becomes more imminent, solar geoengineering is attracting increased consideration and scrutiny as a potential, albeit contentious, tool in the fight against climate change.(Nature)



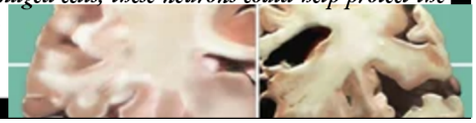
AT&T Stadium crowned most haunted stadium in a shocker

AT&T Stadium in Arlington, Texas, has been named the most haunted sports venue in North America, according to a survey by The Sports Geek. This might surprise fans, as the stadium, affectionately known as "Jerry's World," only opened in 2009. Despite its relatively young age, it surpassed iconic venues like Dodger Stadium and Wrigley Field, which have longer histories. The survey considered factors such as haunted lore, proximity to burial sites, and other eerie attributes. Former stadium employee Selena Sixtos recounted strange experiences, including poltergeist-like activity and unexplained chills, adding to the venue's reputation. While these ghostly tales may be intriguing, it's unlikely they impact the Dallas Cowboys' performance.(Fox)



Scientists discover a surprising clue to why some brains resist Alzheimer's

Researchers at the Netherlands Institute for Neuroscience have uncovered intriguing insights into cognitive resilience against Alzheimer's disease. While some individuals exhibit brain changes associated with Alzheimer's, they never develop dementia symptoms, potentially due to a rare group of cells known as immature neurons. Rather than solely replacing damaged ones, these cells may play a protective role. This phenomenon, called cognitive resilience, highlights the brain's ability to maintain function despite disease-related damage. However, the exact role of these neurons remains unclear, and researchers caution that these findings represent just one part of a complex puzzle, with multiple factors likely contributing to cognitive resilience. Their findings suggest that immature neurons may behave differently in people who resist Alzheimer's symptoms. Rather than simply replacing damaged cells, these neurons could help protect the brain from the harmful effects of the disease. Although the results offer an intriguing explanation for cognitive resilience, the researchers have not established exactly what these immature neurons do. This research represents a promising step in understanding how some brains resist Alzheimer's damage.



Jokes

Biology: It's cell-f explanatory!

Link to previous issues:

PhET

Acai Kheer

Ingredients

- - 400 ml coconut milk
- - 60 g small pearl tapioca
- - 150 ml acai juice (unsweetened)
- - 50 g raw cashews
- - 60 g cane sugar
- - 2 crushed cardamom pods
- - 1 g salt

1. In a dry skillet, gently toast the cashews over medium heat until golden, roughly chop them, and set aside.
2. In a saucepan, combine coconut milk, 40 g sugar, crushed cardamom pods, and a pinch of salt. Bring to a gentle simmer over medium heat.
3. Stir in the small pearl tapioca. Lower heat and simmer for 15 minutes, stirring continuously until pearls turn translucent and tender.
4. Discard cardamom pods, divide the warm tapioca pudding evenly into three serving ramekins, and let cool slightly.
5. In a small saucepan, simmer the açaí juice with the remaining 20 g sugar for 8 minutes until it reduces to a light, glossy syrup.
6. Drizzle the warm açaí reduction over the tapioca puddings and garnish with the toasted cashews before serving warm or chilled.



9	7		5	B	4	G			2		C	D	F	A	
4		8	G		6		9		1	3					
	3	E	A	D	1	8		9	7		5	C	6		
C	D	6			5	E	F	A	8	G		B		9	
D	E	2	F	G	C		8	B	A	9	3	6	5	1	4
1	A			9	F		4	C	E	6	8	3		D	
		5	8	6		2			4	7	1	F		E	A
6	9		4	1	A	B		5		2		8			
G	1	A		5		4		8	B			9	7	C	
	6		B		E	A	G		9	5		1	2	3	F
E			9			1		D		C	G	A	4		B
		4	C	F		3	B				E	5		G	D
2	F	C	D	E	G					4	B	7		8	
	G		E	3		D	1	2	F	8	6	4	C	B	
					B	F	5		C	D	9		A	2	6
5		B	6	2				7			A				3